summarizing the administration's China White Paper, Acheson asserted, "It is abundantly clear that we must face the situation as it exists in fact. We will not help the Chinese or ourselves by basing our policy on wishful thinking."[8] While there was public opposition to recognizing the communists as China's leaders, there was little pushback to this cautious policy.[9] That also gave Acheson the space to consider fostering a wedge between Moscow and the Chinese communists, including by continuing contacts with the latter.[10]

This approach was complicated, however, by growing congressional opposition to the administration's China policy in the summer and fall of 1949. Members of the China bloc in Congress, part of a China lobby consisting of academics, businesspersons, diplomats, labor, media persons, and military officials, strongly advocated for support and aid to the GMD, and even direct US military intervention. Their views, however, did not gain traction at that stage.[11]

But India did gain traction as China seemed to be "falling" to communism. Rhetoric from both conservatives and liberals linked China and India. GMD supporters, including Senator William Knowland (R-CA), Representative Walter Judd (R-MN), former diplomat William Bullitt, and retired general Claire Lee Chennault, who had served in the China-Burma-India theater, warned that if China fell, then all of Asia, even India, would fall to communism.[12] Among others, the idea of India as part of the solution to the Asia problem took hold, with some suggesting that the US not only increase aid to the GMD but also offer military assistance to countries like Burma and India. Yet others argued that rather than providing more aid to the GMD, the administration should consider other approaches in Asia that included India, such as a Pacific Pact, or increased economic assistance to India, where communists were "pressing hard."[13] Senator Hubert Humphrey (D-MN) noted that democratic India was "the logical choice" for a "new start" in Asia.[14] Some advocates of economic aid to India also used the fall of China to push their cause.[15] *Life* magazine hailed Nehru as "Asia's greatest statesman.… If we can find the right formula for joining our strength with his, the future of Asia and the world will become much brighter."[16] By September, *The Economist* was commenting on the increased American commentary about "India as a bulwark against Asiatic Communism."[17]